

Comment-to-DM Automation in GoHighLevel

Beginner step-by-step guide — Graeham Watts / Intero Real Estate. Replaces ManyChat. When someone comments a keyword on your Instagram or Facebook post, GHL auto-DMs them, asks buying or selling, and drops them into the CRM.

What you'll end up with: A follower comments "HOME" on your post → they instantly get a friendly DM → they tap "Buying" or "Selling" → they're tagged, added to the right pipeline, and enrolled in New Leads follow-up — all automatically, inside GHL.

Before you start — connect accounts (one-time)

A. Connect Facebook + Instagram to GHL

GHL → Settings → Integrations

Click Connect on Facebook, log in, allow permissions. Instagram must be a Business account linked to your Facebook Page. Both should show "Connected."

B. Turn on keyword DMs in Meta

business.facebook.com (Meta Business Suite)

Enable automated replies to comments/keywords. Without this, Meta blocks the DM.

Build the automation (a Workflow)

Tip: look for the pre-built "Instagram Comment Automation" Recipe to start with most of this done.

1. Create the workflow

Automation → Workflows

Click + Create Workflow → Start from Scratch. Rename it "IG/FB Comment → DM → Qualify".

2. Add the trigger

Add New Trigger → Instagram Comment on Post (or Facebook). Under Filters: Comment → Contains Phrase → your keyword (HOME / BUY / SELL). Turn ON "Track First Level Comments Only."

3. Add the DM action

Click + → Actions → Communication

Choose Instagram Interactive Messenger. Reply Type = Reply to Comment via DM (takes it private). Body: "Hey! Thanks for commenting. Are you looking to buy or sell? Tap below."

4. Add qualifying buttons

Add Quick Replies: Buying / Selling / Just browsing. Each one auto-creates its own branch on the canvas.

5. Set wait + no-answer path

Set the Wait Step to ~30 minutes. Non-responders fall into the Default Timeout branch — add a nudge DM or a "No Response" tag there.

6. Fill each branch

Buying branch: Add Tag (Buyer, Source: IG Comment), add to Buyer pipeline, optional follow-up DM.
Selling branch: same with Seller tag/pipeline. This lands the lead in the CRM and feeds New Leads follow-up.

7. Save, publish, test

Save, flip Publish on, then test before relying on it.

How to test it

You need a real comment to truly test. From another account, comment your keyword on the connected post. Within a minute you should get the DM with buttons. Tap one and confirm the contact appears in GHL → Contacts with the right tag/pipeline. If nothing happens, re-check the two "Before you start" connections — that's the #1 cause.

Limits to know (Meta's rules, not GHL's)

Limit	What it means
24-hour window	Automated DMs only within 24h of the person's last interaction (same for ManyChat).
7-day comment reply	The comment→DM reply must go out within 7 days.
Quick Replies + attachments	Can't combine in one message — send a file in a separate step.
Business account	Instagram must be a Business account linked to your FB Page.

Why this over ManyChat: same comment→DM→qualify→capture flow, already included in GHL (\$0 extra), and the lead lands straight in the CRM with no bridge. ManyChat kept only as backup for extra channels or its slicker builder.